

5.3.2 Cognitive Psychology

Cognitive psychology aims to understand the internal mental processes involved in interpreting and making sense of the world around us. This sub-section deals with two important areas of cognitive psychology: memory and perception.

Memory

Candidates should:

- be aware of the encoding, storage and retrieval stages of memory;
- show knowledge and understanding of Atkinson and Shiffrin's two-process theory;
- be able to describe and evaluate theories of forgetting e.g. interference, motivated forgetting;
- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the use of organisation and imagery in aiding memory (mnemonics) applications e.g. study skills.

Perception

The focus is on visual perception although detailed knowledge of the visual system is not required.

Candidates should:

- show knowledge and understanding of visual constancies, depth cues and illusions;
- consider the role of nature in the development of perceptual abilities e.g. infant (neonate) studies, deprivation studies;
- consider the role of nurture in the development of perceptual abilities e.g. cross-cultural studies, readjustment studies;
- be able to evaluate the research on the development of perceptual abilities in the light of the nature/nurture debate.